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eBook

The Missing Layer in Enterprise AI Coworkers

Your Guide to Governed Decision-Ready Context



Contents

Introduction **3**

The AI coworker gap in enterprise decisions 3

What makes context decision-ready 3

Why Generic AI Assistants Fall Short **5**

Most business work is really data work 5

Put Unified Context to Work With Genie One **6**

The Living Context Layer Behind Genie **7**

A living business context layer 7

Governance in the loop 7

Prescriptive Moves for Business Leaders **8**

Introduction

The AI coworker gap In enterprise decisions

AI assistants are quickly spreading across the surface layer of work. They draft emails, summarize meetings and answer questions with impressive fluency. But in the places where businesses actually run, such as forecast calls, deal reviews and operational standups, they rarely change outcomes.

The problem is twofold.

1. The context that business decisions depend on is scattered across systems, teams and definitions. No one sees quite the same version of the business, whether it's a CMO looking at campaign results or a CFO reviewing quarterly performance.

2. Most AI assistants aren't built for this kind of work. They're effective at quick, self-contained tasks like searching a code base, but they struggle to follow data, definitions and workflows across systems and business processes.

What makes context decision-ready

Most companies already have the data they need: CRM records, dashboards, spreadsheets and a constant stream of signals from across the business. The issue isn't access. It's that these pieces don't line up into a single, trusted view, so leaders struggle to get accurate and consistent insights they can take action on.

Decision-ready context means more than having data in one place. It's a shared map that provides a clear, connected picture of how the business works. When that map exists, teams can work from the same definitions and follow how a number is built. In a forecast call, for example, a sales leader can see how today's pipeline ties to product usage, open support issues and account history in a single view, instead of trying to stitch those signals together manually.

Without that shared context, teams spend time reconciling numbers, debating definitions and jumping between tools to figure out which deals are real and which are at risk. The question is rarely “do we have the data?” It’s whether that data can be interpreted together with enough consistency and accuracy to change the decision.

In this eBook, you’ll learn:

- Why generic AI assistants stall on real business decisions
- What decision-ready context is and why it changes outcomes
- How Genie One puts unified context to work
- How governance lets AI scale into higher-stakes decisions
- Where to start, with prescriptive moves for business leaders

Why Generic AI Assistants Fall Short

Most business work is really data work

Most general-purpose assistants are designed to interpret a prompt, retrieve what is easiest to access and produce a fluent and confident response. While that's sufficient for many business productivity tasks, business users quickly feel the limits because most modern business work is really data work.

Ahead of a forecast call, a sales leader might ask a generic assistant which deals are most likely to close. The assistant can scan the CRM and return a neat list based on stage and recent activity, but it won't automatically factor in product usage trends, open support issues or changes in account plans. It helps with one slice of the picture at a time — usually whatever has been explicitly given to it — so its answers can sound confident without being reliably grounded in the full context the decision depends on.

uplight™

"By bringing Genie One capabilities to our data, we're enabling teams across Uplight to explore, discover and innovate with more speed, confidence and creativity than ever before. This is the promise of data democratization — enabling a culture where curiosity, data-informed decision-making and innovation can happen at every level of the company."

- Micaela Christopher, Director of Data Science and Engineering, Uplight

Put Unified Context to Work With Genie One

Genie One is the AI assistant for data-driven work that runs on unified context. Rather than treating each question as a standalone interaction, Genie One uses a shared context layer that spans Databricks data, documents, SaaS applications and operational systems. The point is not simply to answer faster. It's to let business users ask questions, interpret accurate answers in business terms and carry that understanding reliably into follow-up work without reconstructing the backstory each time.

- **Ask once, where the work happens:** Genie One brings unified context into the tools where people already work. This means business users can ask questions in tools like Slack, Microsoft Teams, mobile, MCP or dashboards and get answers and insights grounded in governed, real-time data.
- **From insights into actions:** Genie One provides agentic cowork capabilities so users can schedule tasks, draft documents, generate reports and trigger workflows in connected tools. Through Genie One, they can also create agents that turn recurring use cases, like forecast prep, QBR packets or escalation workflows, into shareable agents that automate those tasks.
- **Apply governance automatically:** Answers, actions and agents inherit permissions and governance controls from the business, keeping everything aligned with existing access rules and oversight

Together, this lowers the cost of getting to a decision: less time reconciling numbers before every meeting, fewer fragmented tools to stitch together and decisions that move from days to minutes without trading off accuracy or control.

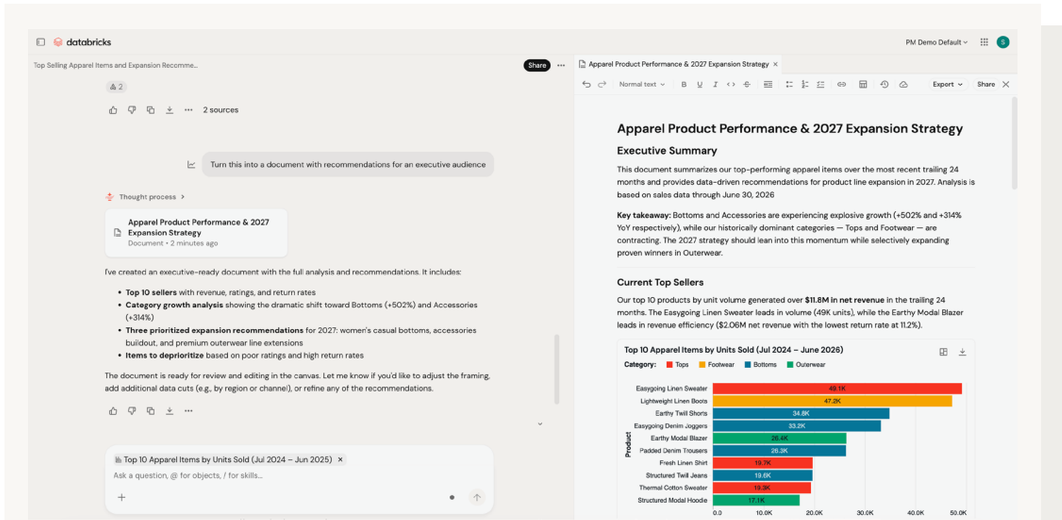


Figure 1. Genie apparel expansion analysis — from a single prompt, Genie goes beyond analysis to a full executive-ready document, complete with imagery.

The Living Context Layer Behind Genie

A living business context layer

At the center of this approach is Genie Ontology, a unified context layer that reflects how the business actually operates, not just how data is stored. It learns from data, dashboards, queries, documents and connected applications, then organizes business terms, metrics, entities and relationships into a living knowledge graph.

That matters because context in enterprises isn't static. Definitions evolve, ownership shifts and new signals emerge. Genie Ontology ranks definitions and signals using factors such as usage and links to certified assets, which helps determine what should count as authoritative in a given situation.

Consider a marketing leader asking which campaigns are truly driving the pipeline. A useful answer can't stop at top-of-funnel metrics. It has to connect campaigns to segments, channels, opportunities in the CRM, closed-won revenue and downstream product usage, then explain the result in the same terms the organization already uses to measure impact. That's the difference between context that's available on the surface and context that can support a decision.

Governance in the loop

As AI moves closer to core business decisions, governance is a core requirement rather than a separate control layer: An AI assistant that can read live data and take action needs clear permissions, lineage and oversight.

This is where Unity Catalog and Genie Ontology work together. Unity Catalog governs access, certified data and shared definitions, including metrics and business terms. Genie Ontology builds on that foundation to create a business-aware map, combining those governed assets with context learned from across the organization.

In practice, this means a finance analyst asking about revenue sees only approved data and certified definitions, while Genie can still connect related signals, like pipeline or usage, across systems. The result is AI that works within the rules of the business while using a broader, connected view of context to support decisions in a way that's both trusted and reliable.

Prescriptive Moves for Business Leaders

For leaders who want AI coworkers to deliver measurable impact, a few patterns work well:

- **Start with work that already matters —** Pick recurring use cases where teams already spend time reconciling data, such as forecast calls or planning cycles. Use them as pilots, turn the best patterns into agents and track prep time, accuracy or cycle time.
- **Anchor AI in a company-owned context layer —** Treat the context model as an enterprise asset that's reusable across teams, assistants and models. Because that context lives with you rather than inside any single model or harness, you can adopt new models without losing your data ground truth or context.
- **Use governance to enable scale —** Make sure AI coworkers inherit the data and access controls you already use, so they can move into higher-stakes work without adding new rules. When policies reflect how you want decisions made, governance becomes a way to expand where AI is used.

Example use cases

- Consolidate campaign performance details across CRM, dashboards and documents into a complete view of progress and opportunities
- Project and model forecasted operating expenses from your phone, without engaging an analyst or writing any code
- Prepare for customer QBRs with a full view of account data, open support tickets and past meeting notes with a simple prompt

Stop settling for answers.
Start making decisions — see how.

Get started

There's a growing gap between AI that produces answers and AI that can take part in real decisions. Closing that gap starts with unified, decision-ready context.

Genie One is built for that shift, bringing data, decisions and actions into a single, governed AI coworker.

Explore Genie and start asking follow-up questions of your own data: databricks.com/genie

Additional resources

Get Started With Genie One: Top AI Cowork Use Cases for Business Users | Databricks Blog

Learn five practical Genie One workflows business users can set up fast — from reporting and meeting prep to document automation, alerts and reusable AI agents.

Designing Effective Genie Agents From a Single Prompt | Databricks Blog

Learn how to turn trusted business context into production-ready, domain-specific AI agents in a single prompt.

Making AI Deliver: A Benchmarking Framework for Operationalizing AI

Access the **Economist Enterprise report** that surveyed 1,200 leaders to provide a benchmarking framework for operationalizing AI.

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About Databricks

Databricks is the data and AI company. More than 20,000 organizations worldwide — including adidas, AT&T, Bayer, Block, Mastercard, Rivian, Unilever and 70% of the Fortune 500 — rely on Databricks to build and scale data and AI apps, analytics and agents. Headquartered in San Francisco, with 30+ offices around the globe, Databricks offers a unified platform that includes Lakebase, Genie, Agent Bricks, Lakeflow, Lakehouse and Unity Catalog. To learn more, follow Databricks on LinkedIn, X, YouTube and Instagram.

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